# FMAM 2026 rainfall outlook

ECMWF SEAS5 initialized 1 February 2026 · calibrated with CHIRPS v3.0 · FMAM rainfall contribution domain

**Research reconstruction — not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast**

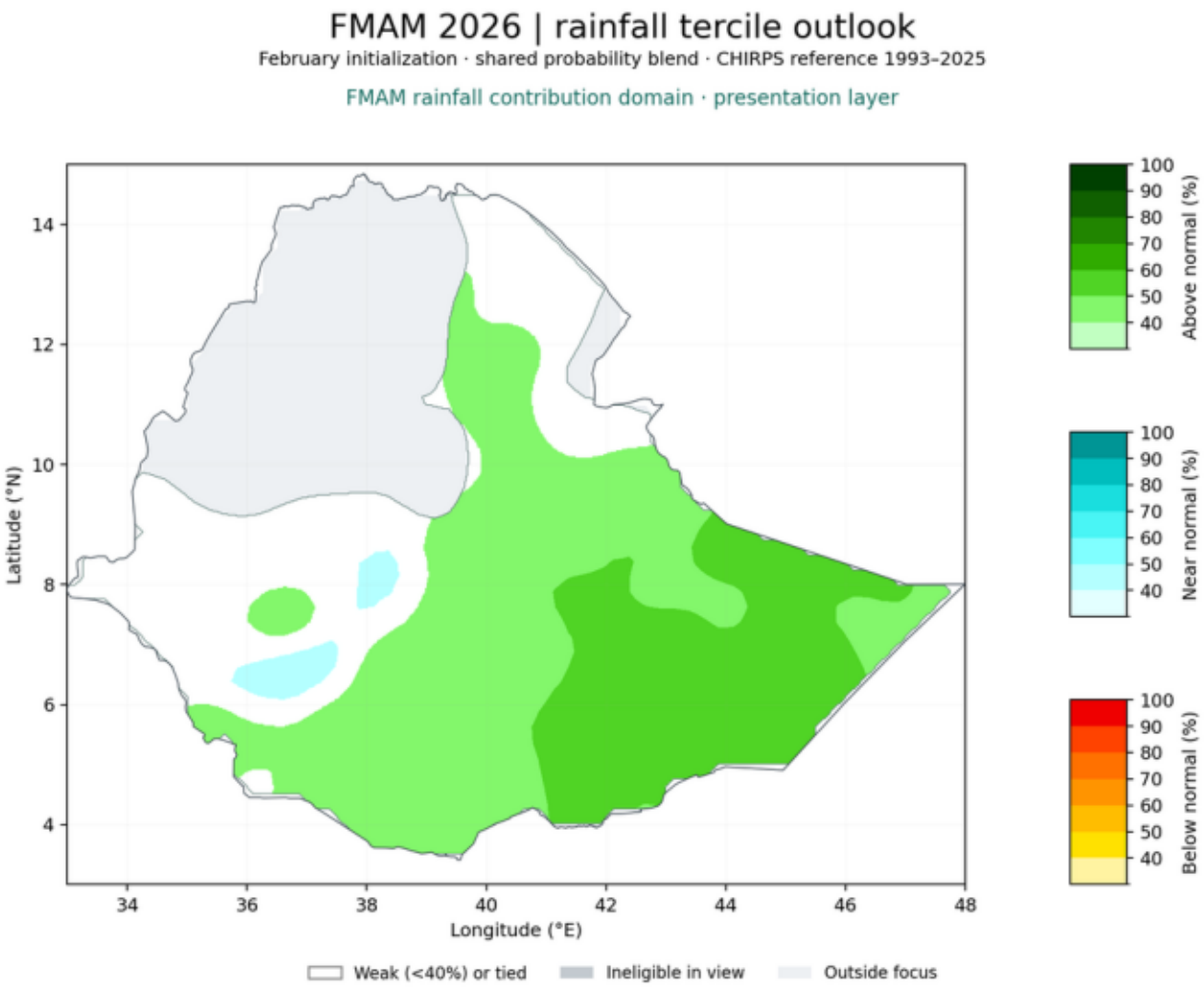
The forecast leans toward above normal rainfall in the FMAM rainfall contribution domain: averaged over the area, the local probability of above normal is 44%, against about 33% for climatology. Mean forecast rainfall is 347 mm against a 1993–2025 average of 310 mm (+37 mm, +12%).

**Below normal 23%** **Near normal 32%** **Above normal 44%**

Average local probability: each grid cell has its own tercile probabilities; these are their averages over the 100% of the area that has probabilities, not the probability that the area-total rainfall falls in a category.

Forecast signal: Moderate tilt toward above normal (largest area-average probability compared with a one-third reference; based on probabilities only).

Historical skill (FMAM rainfall contribution domain): Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain. Probability skill (RPSS) +0.017, cross-validated 1993–2016, 95% interval −0.038 to +0.067; better than climatology in 15 of 24 years. A strong signal is not a confidence rating.




Display only: 12× interpolation; Gaussian σ=1.5 native cells (≈0.38°, softens the 1° model grid). Statistics and exported fields use the original 0.25° grid.
Research reconstruction of a February-initialized forecast; not an official EMI/ICPAC product.

# All targets, evidence and record

FMAM 2026 — February initialization · FMAM rainfall contribution domain

| Target | Below/near/above | Coverage | Anomaly | Verification status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| FMAM 2026 | 23% / 32% / 44% | 100% | +37 mm | Verification published |
| Feb 2026 | 33% / 39% / 29% | 91% | −3 mm | Verification published |
| Mar 2026 | 31% / 34% / 36% | 100% | +7 mm | Verification published |
| Apr 2026 | 27% / 31% / 42% | 100% | +32 mm | Verification published |
| May 2026 | 34% / 34% / 32% | 100% | −2 mm | Verification published |

### Historical skill, cross-validated (probability skill, RPSS, with whole-year 95% interval)

| Target | RPSS (95% interval) | Yrs better | Holm p | In words |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| FMAM | +0.017 (−0.038 to +0.067) | 15/24 | 1.000 | Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain |
| Feb | +0.137 (+0.050 to +0.234) | 16/24 | 0.012 | Moderate improvement over climatology (interval above zero) |
| Mar | +0.011 (−0.020 to +0.042) | 15/24 | 1.000 | Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain |
| Apr | +0.011 (−0.032 to +0.048) | 16/24 | 1.000 | Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain |
| May | +0.007 (−0.051 to +0.050) | 17/24 | 1.000 | Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain |

### Verification against CHIRPS (single season or month)

| Target | RPSS | CRPSS | Bias | Forecast / observed anomaly | Observed below/near/above |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FMAM 2026 | +0.006 | −0.081 | +2.6 mm | +37 / +35 mm | 13% / 40% / 47% |
| Feb 2026 | +0.009 | +0.028 | −1.1 mm | −3 / −1 mm | 33% / 45% / 22% |
| Mar 2026 | +0.080 | +0.081 | −62.6 mm | +7 / +69 mm | 0% / 4% / 96% |
| Apr 2026 | −0.187 | −0.648 | +53.9 mm | +32 / −22 mm | 45% / 39% / 16% |
| May 2026 | +0.002 | −0.031 | +9.2 mm | −2 / −11 mm | 37% / 46% / 17% |

### Cycle record

Model initialization: 1 February 2026 · ECMWF SEAS5 (system 51), 51 members

Target period: 1 Feb 2026 – 31 May 2026

Forecast record: Frozen 10 Oct 2026. Recalibrated with CHIRPS v3.0 when its observations for Feb 2026–May 2026 were already available (the fit itself uses 1993–2025 only): a retrospective reconstruction, not a forecast frozen before its outcome (SHA-256 manifest)

Publication status: Research reconstruction: produced after the initialization date with the published method; not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

Reference period: CHIRPS v3.0 FMAM 1993–2025 (33 seasons)

Observations processed through: May 2026 (Feb, Mar, Apr, May)

CHIRPS archive: Official CHIRPS v3.0 monthly listing checked 11 Oct 2026: monthly files through Aug 2026

Verification last run: 11 Oct 2026

Method / version: Shared climatology blend (λ = 0.40 for FMAM) · code 007ce47

How to read: terciles split the reference-period rainfall into three equally likely parts. Climatology assigns about one-third to each (the observed tercile frequencies of the training years). Skill scores are decimals: +0.05 means a 5% lower score than climatology. RPSS refers to the blended probabilities; CRPSS and bias to the amount-corrected ensemble.

Limitations: few evaluation years and single verification seasons give wide uncertainty; the 0.25° maps repeat ~1° model information; the rainfall domain is for display and summaries only.

# Monthly tercile outlooks

FMAM 2026 — February initialization · FMAM rainfall contribution domain

